

After Action Review for Philippines Haiyan Typhon

Report by

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Acronyms

AAR	After Action Review
ACTED	Agency for Technical Cooperation and Development
ADRA	Adventist Development and Relief Agency
BCPR	Bureau For Crisis Prevention and Recovery
BOM	Bureau of Management
CB	Crisis Board
CD	Country Director
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund
CfW	Cash for Work
CO	Country Office (UNDP)
CRS	Catholic Relief Services
DfID	Department for International Development (UK)
DOCO	UN Development Operations Coordination Office (DOCO)
DRR/M	Disaster Risk Reduction/Management
DSWD	Department of Social Welfare and Development
EB	Executive Board
ER	Early Recovery
ERA	Early Recovery Advisor
ERCC	Early Recovery Cluster Advisor
ERL	Early Recovery and Livelihoods
ET	Executive Team
FTP	Fast Track Procedures
HQ	Head Quarters (UNDP)
HC	Humanitarian Coordinator
IAHE	Inter-Agency Humanitarian evaluation
IARRM	Inter-Agency Rapid Response Mechanism
IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee
IFI	International Financial Institution
ILO	International Labour Organization
IM	Information Management
HCT	Humanitarian Country Team
MIC	Middle Income Country
MIRA	Multi Sector Inter-Cluster Rapid Assessment
MSB	Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency
MSF	Medecins Sans Frontieres
NDRRMC	National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council
NDCC	National Disaster Coordinating Council
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NGWA	National Goodwill Ambassadors
OCD	Office of Civil Defense
OCHA	Office of Coordination for Humanitarian Affairs (UN)
PDNA	Post-Disaster Needs Assessment
RBAP	Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (UNDP)

RC	Resident Coordinator
RM	Resource Mobilization
RR	Resident Representative
SOP	Standard Operating Procedures
SPT	SURGE Planning Team
SRC	Senior Recovery Coordinator
SRP	Strategic Response Plan
TA	Transformation Agenda
TRRV	Typhoon Resilience and Recovery in the Visayas
UNCT	UN Country Team
UNDG	UN Development Group
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
WFP	World Food Programme
YRP	Yolanda Recovery Programme

Executive Summary

On 8 November 2013, Typhoon Haiyan (locally known as Yolanda) made landfall in the Philippines. Over 14 million people in 36 provinces were affected, with over 6,000 deaths and more than 4 million displaced. The devastation was so severe that, despite its substantial capacities, the government accepted the offer of international assistance.¹ The IASC Principals formally declared the international response to Typhoon Haiyan a system-wide level 3 emergency on 12 November 2013.

UNDP initiated this After Action Review (AAR) to examine the organisation's performance of UNDP in its response to Typhoon Haiyan, and highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning of UNDP response to disasters. The AAR is not an evaluation. It is a review based on the reflections, views and suggestions of actors on the ground. Evidence was gathered through document review and key informant interviews.

The report considers six aspects of UNDP actions: initial response, programmatic response, operational response, UN and interagency coordination, engagement in the wider planning process, and resource mobilisation. The main finding of the review is that, broadly speaking, UNDP action in response to Typhoon Haiyan was swift and strong. As may be expected, however, several lessons emerged that should inform future organisational crisis response action. These areas are broadly summarised here.

Decision-making

Immediate organisational response action was robust and decisive. Crisis Board meetings were convened promptly, decisions taken quickly, and SURGE Deployment was rapid as required. A Senior Recovery Coordinator (SRC) with strong leadership qualities was on the ground within two weeks and substantial financing was committed.

Leadership

Necessary leadership action was typically recognised and demanded, but follow through could have been firmer. For instance, the unusual complexity of the Philippines' country office context could have been better addressed. The circumstances indicated to HQ the need for an SRC at a high level of seniority and an appropriate decision was made, showing a high degree of organisational commitment. However, the multiple layers of tensions it generated could have been anticipated: the tension between the SRC and the CD the consequences of this tension for the coherence of the response, and the effects on the organisations image.

Whole-of-UNDP mobilisation

At HQ level, all the relevant players were involved and active, and communication with the team on the ground was regular. At the country level, the old UNDP problem of negative dynamics between a SURGE team and the national team was strongly in play for several reasons. The receptiveness to the SURGE support team was weak, partly due to a lack of familiarity with the implications of a L3 crisis. Related, perhaps, to the leadership tension mentioned above, CO leadership of the response was not asserted and SURGE support was seen as an intrusion.

¹ Operational Peer Review Philippines

Programme Priorities

There was divergence between a planned intervention (anchored on UNDP's mandate) and what actually happened in the ground. UNDP budgeted \$65 million and provided seed capital of \$5 million for the recovery programme. The expectation that resources would be mobilised in the first 3 months was not met. UNDP was not well positioned to raise this amount of money in that time frame. The consequence is that resource mobilisation ceased to be strategic and became opportunistic, and activities began to be determined essentially by what could be funded.

UNDP's initial focus on debris clearance and waste management was essential, as these constitute conditions precedent to life saving humanitarian activities. The organisation's performance on this score was widely commended. But this success may, ironically, have impeded the pursuit of the organisation's main role in crisis situations, which is to foster through the restoration of local economies the early return to a decent quality of life for the women and men whose livelihoods have been lost or severely impaired by the disaster. In the process of mobilising resources in the critical first six weeks, UNDP seems, unwittingly, to have projected debris clearance and waste management as ends in themselves, rather than the foundation for early recovery.

Operational Support

Among the most important implications of an L3 crisis is the need for quick action and decision-making in the field within very compressed timelines. This need often clashed with the organisation's normal compliance requirements, and actors on the ground were placed in a situation of have to bear the full burden of risk taken in the interest of the organisation. The SRC often had to stretch the rules in order to deliver effectively. The SOP was not sufficiently empowering.

UN and inter-agency coordination

Some key informants recalled that strategic discussions were limited within the HCT throughout the SRP. Discussions were dominated by agency mandates rather than by interagency or inter-sectoral issues. As a result, the final strategic objectives are more a reflection of cluster lead agency sectoral priorities.

Due to a peculiarity of the cluster system in the Philippines, livelihood and early recovery were initially separate. The corresponding lack of clarity on the cluster leadership roles of UNDP and ILO hampered effective coordination. Too much time was lost in unproductive interagency disagreement until the IASC Principals instructed that the two clusters be merged.

In relation to UNDP's coordination role, several partners pointed out that UNDP did not abide rigorously by the "firewall" between its coordination role and its programmatic work as a member of the ERL. It seems that due to resource constraints, so-called ER coordinators were diverted into UNDP programme work, reflecting badly on the organisation.

Wider Planning process

Post-Disaster Needs Assessments (PDNAs), conducted under the leadership of governments, are typically the framework for national recovery programmes, and the base document for discussions about international development assistance. There was a difference of opinion regarding the need for a PDNA between the National Economic and Development Authority (NEDA), which has the mandate for it, and the Office of Civil Defense, which in charge of Yolanda recovery efforts. This

divergence fed into the long-running substantive and methodological tension on PDNAs between UNDP and the World Bank, in spite of the ‘Joint Declaration on Post-Crisis Assessments and Recovery Planning’ signed by the two organizations and the EU in 2008. Although the declaration committed the agencies to participating using a common approach, UNDP and the World Bank (the EU was not active in Manila) did not have a common approach to engaging with the government. Indeed the two agencies were speaking to different government entities, the UN to the OCD and the World Bank (with ADB) to NEDA.

Resource mobilization

UNDP’s programme for support to recovery was about \$65 million, which is only about 40 percent funded to date (including contributions from UNDP and DOCO). Several factors contributed to the underfunding. First, UNDP appears not to have been sufficiently prepared in terms of leadership, organisation and thematic clarity to elicit great interest from donors. There was no clear strategy on how to engage donors to contribute to UNDP’s role in crisis response. Although the resource mobilization guidelines were followed substantially, beginning with convening a resource mobilization task force, the attention to procedural details could not substitute for a substantive strategy, and an approach specifically tailored to the Philippines was not developed. Second UNDP’s name recognition in humanitarian response situations is weak, despite its excellent reputation on debris clearance and waste management. These activities are key in the early response phase, and apparently, no other UN agency has the will or capacity to undertake them. Nonetheless UNDP’s almost total focus on this area in the beginning seems to have compromised its ER agenda and weakened its UNDP’s strategic positioning with donors. Third and perhaps, most significantly, the review team was informed by several actors that UNDP had a serious credibility problem long before Typhoon Haiyan broke. Key donors simply had no faith in UNDP’s programme leadership.

A matrix of key recommendations is presented below.

Table I-1 RECOMMENDATIONS MATRIX

Issue	Recommendations	Action required	Action to be taken by
Organisational & CO capacity & preparedness; CO SURGE requirements	-Strengthen understanding of SOP across UNDP, particularly senior management. -Strengthen CO preparedness for disaster response -Reorient the country programme in the response to major crises. -Ensure better planning and phasing of SURGE deployment	-Build organizational crisis response capability through developing a corps of L3 capable UNDP managers [esp. for RR, CD, DCD (Prog. & Ops)] -Put in place an early warning / early action mechanism, including a methodology for scenario analysis and simulations. -Conduct (for hazard prone countries) periodic simulations of CO response to a L3 crisis. -Enforce the SOP guidelines on HQ-CO consultation on capacity gaps and SURGE support needs -Revise SOPs to mandate the precedence of crisis response and ER programming over regular programme work for the first 30 days after occurrence of major crisis. -Enforce in a L3 level crisis implementation of a mandatory office-wide response that dissolves country programme boundaries for the first 30 days. - Revise SOPs to provide guidance on planning for crises	AA/RBx/BCPR/BOM
Procedures and Processes	Establish appropriate protocols to L3 actions.	-Raise the fast track cash authorization limit to one million dollars; -Allow the use of direct contracting for all purchases below the CO's Delegated Procurement Authority (DPA) during the first month following the occurrence of the crisis/disaster; -Waive the need for international advertisement of procurement cases exceeding US\$ 100,000 – whether as a single contract/PO or as an accumulation of multiple contract/POs, within the first three months following the occurrence of the crisis; -Allow the post-facto submission for CAP review of procurement cases exceeding US\$ 50,000 – whether as a single contract/PO or as an accumulation of multiple contract/POs – during the first three months following the occurrence of the crisis; -In issuing Service Contracts (SC), waive the normal requirements (such as advertising for ten days, shortlisting,	BOM/RBx/BCPR

		interviews and written examination), which may take up to two months. -Develop LTAs for supplies and services that UNDP is likely to require in humanitarian situations (such as PPEs and hand tools).	
Logistic support		-Enter into LTAs with global partner banks for the physical delivery of cash in local currency wherever a UNDP CO needs them, and ensure that local counterparts of the banks are included in the obligations under the agreement. -Arrange for LTAs related to debris clearing and waste management services, with standard specifications/TORs for the various aspects, such as treatment, recycling and incineration. -Establish a UNDP warehouse to store goods commonly procured during emergencies in (or close to) large hazard-prone countries. -Establish a checklist of minimum requirements for setting up a field office in major crisis situations, (taking into consideration various critical factors such as access to energy, water and connectivity).	BOM/RBx/BCPR
Resource mobilization and marketing UNDP as a key actor in humanitarian response	Include a Resource Mobilization (RM) person in the SURGE planning team to design and lead implementation of a RM strategy. Hazard vulnerable countries, should engage a resource mobilization expert to develop and manage long-term relations with donors on the ground. UNDP should establish a reserve fund for hazard vulnerable countries to serve as first call cash in the event of a disaster Review signature services for UNDP in post crisis setting and	-Provide an annex to the SOP on “how to design a RM strategy” for disaster-prone countries. -Include the guidance note in the briefing packages for RRs and CDs on every assignment or reassignment; -Revise guidance notes (or develop new ones) that link signature services to the logic of saving lives in emergencies, while grounding them firmly in the ER domain -Develop tools and guidance notes to ensure effective delivery of such signature services, including practical support tools for CO to roll out recovery programmes. -Integrate UNDP signature products into a broader ER marketing package. -Publish and ensure wide circulation of a ‘little (UNDP) blue book’ that outlines, in simple language, the link between early	BERA/BCPR

	build the organizational capacity to deliver them effectively—to ensure UNDP delivery predictability in crisis response.	response and ER so that donors understand better UNDP roles in disaster (and post conflict) situations.	
ER coordination	Support the empowerment of the HC Enhance UNDP capacity for Early Recovery Cluster Coordination	-The IASC Principals should review the concept note on empowered leadership and determine how best to give HCs substantive authority corresponding to the responsibility placed on them in L3 situations. At corporate level UNDP should work out with ILO operational and policy guidelines on the ERL that will clarify substantively areas of comparative advantage between the two organisations in the early recovery domain. UNDP should invest the necessary resources on dedicated cluster coordination, and pay more attention to the quality of ER cluster coordinators. Deploy experienced, L3-capable and dedicated field coordination capacity early on in the response, and ensure that XPRESS roster contains experienced ER coordinators Improve quality of the ER experts in the roster	EO/DOCO/OCHA/BCPR
Wider Planning Process	Strengthen government capacity to oversee recovery	-Re-initiate discussion to strengthen tripartite agreement between EU, WB and UNDP on a common approach to PDNA. -The HC should approach key external agencies to organise themselves to act jointly in preparation for the next probable crisis. -UNDP should include a PDNA technical specialist in its SURGE deployment for L3 disasters. -In the Philippines, UNDP should provide dedicated support to the government to strengthen comprehensively its mechanisms for managing recovery processes.	EO/DOCO/BCPR

I. Background

On November 8, 2013, Typhoon Haiyan (locally known as Yolanda), one of the strongest typhoons ever to make landfall, cut a path of destruction across the central Philippines, killing more than 6,000 people and displacing approximately four million. Haiyan severely damaged or destroyed over 1.1 million houses – more than six times the number destroyed by the 2010 Haiti earthquake. Approximately 80 percent of all homes in the affected areas were either destroyed or damaged, with rural areas being hit the hardest.

The ERC formally activated an IASC system-wide level 3 (L3) emergency response on 12 November 2013. This led to a surge of human and financial resources and the activation of measures and procedures to establish effective coordination of humanitarian support. The accompanying measures included giving the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) empowered leadership, sending enhanced surge capacity through the Inter-Agency Rapid Response Mechanism (IARRM), and providing a \$25 million allocation from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF).

The Philippines being highly disaster-prone, the government has strong early warning and response mechanisms in place. The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (NDRRMC) and local authorities are leading the typhoon response. Prior to Yolanda's arrival, the government had pre-emptively evacuated 125,604 people to 109 evacuation centres in 22 provinces. Despite its preparedness efforts and immediate response, the Philippine Government announced on 9 November, that it would accept international assistance. On 11 November, President Benigno Aquino declared a state of national calamity.

II. Purpose and methodology of this After Action Review

In both the public and private sectors, post-facto reviews are normal on the conclusion of any major project or action. In accordance with L3 protocols, the UN conducted an Operational Peer Review in February 2014 to assess (i) the leadership arrangements; (ii) application of the humanitarian programme cycle; (iii) use of appropriate coordination arrangements; and (iv) accountability to affected people. Other agencies and international non-governmental organisations (INGOs) have also undertaken assessments of the international response to the crisis and presented lessons learned to the wider development community in the Philippines. In addition an Inter-Agency Humanitarian Evaluation (IAHE) of the response to Haiyan is planned for August 2014, and aimed to improve humanitarian policy-making and action. UNDP has initiated this After Action Review (AAR) to examine the organisation's response to Typhoon Haiyan.

Specifically, the AAR will examine the performance of UNDP in its response to Typhoon Haiyan, and highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning of UNDP response to disasters. Key lessons from the review may also feed into the IAHE process and be shared with partners as a part of collective learning. The terms of reference (TOR) identifies for review six key areas of UNDP's response to the Haiyan Typhoon. These are: immediate response, programmatic response, operational response, UN and inter-agency coordination, engagement in the recovery

process, and resource mobilisation. The expected outputs are a compilation of lessons learned and actionable recommendations for UNDP senior management and responsible teams for improving future crisis responses. (The terms of reference are attached as Annex I)

The exercise began officially on 9 June 2014 with a review team comprising a senior consultant as the team leader and a UNDP Programme Specialist from the Afghanistan Country Office. It was managed by BCPR. Information was gathered from primary and secondary sources. Documents reviewed include situation reports, planning and monitoring frameworks, inter-cluster coordination group and HCT minutes, internal lessons learned, and briefing notes on thematic issues. Key informant interviews were conducted in headquarters with the main bureaus involved (BCPR, BERA, BOM, RBAP). The team undertook a mission to Philippines from 16 to 28 June, including visits to Tacloban City and the municipalities of Guiuan and Salcedo. In the Philippines the team interviewed country office staff and project personnel deployed to the Typhoon- affected areas. It also met with government partners in Manila and the disaster-affected areas, and with other UN agencies such as OCHA, UNICEF, UN-Habitat and civil society organizations (CSOs) such as People In Need and the Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB). A list of persons met is provided as Annex II.

III. UNDP Initial Response

3.1 Actions

When Haiyan Typhoon made landfall, UNDP was convening the Regional Cluster Meeting in Hanoi, Vietnam. In line with the L3 declaration, the organisation responded promptly. A Crisis Board meeting was convened in Hanoi on 10 November 2013. A Disaster Risk Reduction Advisor, an Early Recovery Advisor (ERA) and an Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator (ERCC) were on the ground by 11 November 2013 as part of the Inter Agency Rapid Response Mechanism (IARRM).

UNDP also deployed SURGE advisers promptly. A Senior Recovery Coordinator (SRC) and a Communications Adviser were in place by 15 November 2013, and a Senior Liaison Officer was deployed on 18 November to support the HC in facilitating high-level missions. By 28 November, UNDP had deployed in total a surge team of 16 experts, comprising of 11 staff members, 4 international consultants from the Express Roster and 1 local consultant. Additionally, 15 SURGE members were deployed from 1 December 2013 and by end of January 2014 the total number of SURGE team members were 31.²

Befitting a L3 crisis response, the first two Crisis Board meetings took the most critical decisions. Action points decided at the first meeting on November 10 include the following:

- An Early Recovery coordinator will be deployed immediately from Geneva to support with ER coordination for 2-3 weeks. In parallel longer term coordination capacity will be identified and sourced for the CO.
- A field ER coordinator will be identified and deployed.

² Please refer to Annex III for SURGE Deployment timeline

- Remote assistance would be provided for the development of the Flash Appeal proposal.
- TRAC 113 category II funding will be provided.
- Seed funding for early recovery will also be provided.
- A communication expert will be sourced through the SURGE mechanism

Action points noted at the second meeting on 15 November include:

- The arrival of a Senior Recovery Coordinator in Philippines on the 20 November;
- The deployment of a Senior Liaison Officer on the 18 November to support the HC in facilitating high level missions and resource mobilization efforts;
- The approval by BCPR of \$5 million for early recovery programming and \$100,000 for planning;
- The approval by RBAP of \$100,000 to enhance the CO budget for staffing;
- The tentative agreement on the timing of SURGE planning mission;

Deployment of SURGE planning team

The CO began to respond to the disaster immediately, pending the arrival of a SURGE team. It sent staff from CPR Unit to participate in the Multi-Sector Initial Rapid Assessment (MIRA) (day 2 of the disaster). It also mobilised local staff from Mindanao who had experience in crisis response. Three such staff plus the CPR Team Leader arrived in Tacloban on day 6. These officers facilitated the arrival of two waste management experts (with Aceh experience) on Day 8.

A SURGE planning team, led by the Chief, Country Support Management Team, BCPR, were deployed to Manila from November 24 to December 1 2013. Its mission was to develop an integrated programmatic and operational plan that responds to the immediate needs of the crisis, and assists the CO in thinking through a core resilience-based approach to recovery that will strongly position UNDP in this agenda going forward. Toward that end, the SURGE planning team undertook a capacity mapping of the country office. The mapping showed that the CO has broad experience managing post-disaster recovery programmes peacebuilding initiatives, mostly via the CPR Unit. However, it also indicated that the capacity of this team and that of the Governance team were inadequate to take advantage of programmatic opportunities or manage the challenges of a potential quantum jump in resources.

The SURGE planning team produced a plan describing the required capacity support to the UNDP Philippines Office for an initial period of three months in support of the implementation of a possible \$48 million integrated recovery programme. The programme would

- i. support the removal of debris through providing emergency employment to the affected population
- ii. help restore the capacities of local government and institutions in the typhoon affected areas
- iii. provide support to stabilise and restore the livelihoods of vulnerable communities, and
- iv. contribute to rehabilitating basic and critical community infrastructure and services.

A larger SURGE team of UNDP was subsequently mobilised and deployed to undertake immediate crisis response activities and work on the early recovery programme. This team was

based mainly in Manila, with 5 members based in Tacloban city with travel to Manila. The timeline for initial response is shown below in Box 1.

Box 1. The Timeline for the Initial Response

1. On 8 November 2013, Typhoon Haiyan (locally known as Yolanda) made landfall in the Philippines. Following consultations with the government and the IASC Principals, the ERC formally activated an IASC system-wide level 3 (L3) emergency response on the 10th of November 2013 for 90 days. The L3 was de-activated on 10 February 2014.
2. UNDP responded to the disaster from the first week, with the first Crisis Board meeting taking place on 10 November and an immediate response team consisting of the CPR Regional Practice Coordinator (Sanny Jegillos), ER Advisor (Jahal de Meritens) and ER Cluster Coordinator (Rekha Das) was in place by the 11th. Other SURGE advisers, such as the Senior Recovery Coordinator and Communications Adviser were in place by the 15th.
3. The CO began to respond to the disaster immediately, pending the arrival of a SURGE team. It sent staff from CPR Unit to participate in the Multi-Sector Initial Rapid Assessment MIRA (day 2 of the disaster). It also mobilised local staff from Mindanao who had experience in crisis response. Three such staff plus the CPR Team Leader arrived in Tacloban on Day 6. These officers facilitated the arrival of two waste management experts (with Aceh experience) on Day 8.
4. BCPR deployed a SURGE team on 25 November to initiate the planning for the first three months of the CO response. The team was led by Bruno Lemarquis, and due to the scale of the crisis, committed the time of 2 more staff members from BCPR (Kamal Kishore and Taija Kontinen-Sharp) in addition to an operations colleague from the Bangladesh CO (Mohammad Rafi Tokhi). The SURGE plan was costed at US\$ 1.3 million, which was allocated as funding on the basis of Crisis Board approval on 4 December 2013.
5. A decision was taken by the Crisis Board to deploy a Senior Recovery Coordinator (Yuri Afanasiev, RR/RC in Bosnia) to manage UNDP's overall response to Yolanda and ensure that early recovery programming and coordination took proper shape. The initial deployment was for 3 months from 15 November. However, due to the lack of capacity in the CO, the position was extended until 13 June (with three successive incumbents, Yuri, followed in order by Philip Cooper (Somalia) and Dennis Curry (Nepal)).
6. The BCPR Director immediately committed US\$ 5 million to Haiyan response, which was intended for both the immediate cash-for-work programming and seed funding for the longer-term recovery and resilience programming. This was in addition to the allocation of US\$ 1.3 million budgeted under the SURGE plan as well as the costs to BCPR incurred by deployments outside of the SURGE plan.
7. In addition to the SURGE plan, a BCPR/APRC team designed a 3-year recovery programme for US\$65 million. The budget for the first year of the programme was estimated at US\$46.7 million (also reflected in the Humanitarian Strategic Response Plan). To date, the CO has secured close to US\$ 26 million against the programme (including BCPR's contribution).

Source: Timeline prepared by BCPR for Director of BCPR; Communication from CO, and CO Resource Mobilization Tracking Matrix

The additional members were brought on board to provide support on a wide range of themes, including support to the Resident Coordinator and Humanitarian Coordinator (RC/HC), debris clearance and waste management, disaster risk reduction, local governance and governance, livelihoods and resource mobilisation. Annex II shows the tracking matrix of SURGE deployed staff, including timelines of arrival and departure.

3.2 Findings

Decision Making

UNDP's SOP for Crisis Response provides an organizational and operational framework for quick decision-making and action.³ Level 3 (L3) emergencies require that UNDP mount a full organization-wide response. Senior Management in HQ directs the response, beginning by convening a Crisis Board (CB) Meeting. UNDP organized itself rapidly in following the SOP requirements, with the first CB meeting convened within 48 hours. Subsequent CB meetings were convened regularly, and decisions were taken quickly regarding the SURGE Deployment and the commitment of relatively large financial resources.

Leadership

Leadership is perhaps the most critical element in realizing UNDP's ambition fast, planned, well organized and well resourced. The responsibilities of the AA in Level 3 emergencies include chairing the CB; initiating a review and assessment of CO management capacities with the help of BOM/OHR; effecting quick changes as necessary, including replacing one or more of them for a specific period or indefinitely. In addition, the AA ensures the application of UNDP response best practice by enforcing the use of these SOP's, as advised by BCPR. Apparently, after review of CO management capacities, UNDP top management determined that the CD should be replaced. This swift decision appears to have been compromised by indecisive implementation.

There was, therefore, a predictable tension within the CO leadership in the unique circumstances of Philippines. Conversations with colleagues in Philippines indicate that for as long as the CD was on hand, friction was impossible to avoid. The fact that the SRC institutionally outranked the CD may have aggravated the tension within the office. The continuing ambiguity on the decision-making architecture and on the locus of authority within the CO aggravated the negative dynamics between the team on the ground and the SURGE team, as escaped below.

Compliance with the SOP

In the main, the actions taken under the initial response phase were compliant with the SOP requirements, except perhaps that the Crisis Board meetings were mostly chaired by the RBAP Director, not the AA as indicated in the SOP for L-3 level crises. Moreover two other actions called for in the SOP could were not pursued as effectively as expected: a) communication with CO staff, all staff and external partners and b) discussion and approval of suitable governing structures for UNDP's response. The question of who does what was ambiguous for longer than it should have been. The ambiguity was particularly disruptive in respect to the role of the SRC and the Country Director and, as discussed below, the respective roles of SURGE thematic experts and UNDP Programme Units.

³ The reference SOP document for this review was the "Standard Operating Procedures For Immediate Crisis Response" (Edition 16, November 2012).

In the SOP, the SURGE pre-crisis phase is ostensibly directed to slow-onset crisis situation. However, in the judgment of the review team, the Philippines' chronic disposition to major hazards suggests that it should have had a level of preparedness comparable to that for a slow-onset disaster. In particular, the specific responsibilities of the CO include providing early warning information establishing a Crisis Response Team (COCRT) to support the RR in the preparing, planning and coordinating UNDP immediate crisis response. If a COCRT had been active, it could have undertaken a CO response capacity self-assessment, identifying the major gaps and deficiencies that should be addressed immediately a disaster situation arises. It could also have had in place a staffing matrix of roles, responsibilities and lines of reporting for the SURGE and Early Recovery advisers that might be deployed; established clear communication channels with all staff; provided regular situation reports (SITREPs); and following up on decisions made by the CO senior management team.

It should be noted that HQ responsibilities in such situations also include an assessment of the CO response capacity (to complement the CO's analysis) and its management capacity. This assessment is expected to take account of events likely to occur that might radically alter the programmatic and operational demands on the CO. Even at this pre-crisis phase the AA may conduct confidential consultations in order to ensure that the CO has the requisite management and leadership capacity.⁴

Application of whole-of-UNDP approach

Given the multi-dimensional nature of the Yolanda recovery process, it had been determined that an integrated whole-of-UNDP approach would be adopted in the response. The SURGE planning team recommended that the response build on the strengths of all programme sections in the Manila Country Office. An integrated approach seems to have been adopted at HQ as can be evidenced from the attendance and the actions taken at the Crisis Board Meetings.⁵ As required by the SOP, CB attendance included, from the CO, the RR/RC, the CD and the CPR Team Leader. On the ground, however, an integrated approach proved more difficult to implement. In the first place, the majority of the CO staff was not familiar with UNDP's crisis response protocols, and many did not understand the implications of an L3 crisis situation. Moreover, the office had never been involved as a whole in managing a crisis of this magnitude, despite the regularity of disaster

⁴ To be clear, the SOP does not require the HQ or CO to do this for sudden-onset disasters. But they should have, considering the chronic vulnerability of the Philippines.

⁵ **CB Meeting 10 November 2013 Attendance:**

- Nicholas Rosellini, Deputy Director, RBAP (Chair)
- Jens Wandel, Director, BOM
- Luiza Carvalho, RR/RC Philippines
- Toshihiro Tanaka, CD Philippines
- Alma Evangelista, CPR Team Leader Philippines
- Vineet Bhatia, Division Chief, RBAP
- Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Practice Coordinator, APRC
- Devanand Ramiah, Portfolio Manager, BCPR

occurrence in the country. Incorrectly taking it for granted, perhaps, that staff was fully familiar with the SOP, management spent no time explaining its requirements. In particular, the SOP requires that the RR establish a COCRT immediately on the onset of a disaster. If in place, the COCRT would have supported the RR and CD in the preparing, planning and coordinating UNDP's immediate crisis response. It would have collaborated with SURGE planning team and ensured that the response was led and owned from the beginning by the CO. Unfortunately, this does not appear to have happened.

On the whole, the CPR and operations sections responded very positively in working with the SURGE team. But it proved difficult to secure the involvement of the other programme teams. In conversations with these programme staff they suggested that their expertise could have been tapped in forming the SURGE team and that national expertise could have been called upon before bringing in the SURGE planning team (as some other UN agencies had done). They saw the SURGE team as crowding them out by duplicating existing technical capacities. Beginning with the SURGE planning team, many national staff perceived the external support colleagues as having come in with a "Messiah complex" to "save" the CO.⁶ Perhaps most seriously, many national staff complained that they were treated with condescension, including by the SRC, even those who were trying so hard to do support crisis response and recovery efforts.

On the other hand, many in the SURGE planning team felt that the non-CPR programme leadership was simply impervious to all their earnest entreaties seeking the involvement of CO colleagues in the recovery efforts. Our discussions with a larger cross section of CO staff appeared to support the view that despite the best efforts of the SURGE planning team these staff members were simply unwilling to engage in the preparation of the SURGE plan, not to mention the implementation of the plan. Such "dialogue of the deaf" could have been avoided, perhaps if HQ and the CO had implemented some of the relevant aspects of the SOP.⁷

The SURGE planning team members had the advantage of being familiar with each other's work, and knowing each other's strengths and personality traits by virtue of having worked together in previous missions and being part of the same office in New York. The strong sense of team commitment, and trust enabled operational effectiveness. But it may have had the unintended consequence of creating a larger gap between the team and the CO colleagues.

3.2 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

- i. UNDP should specifically provide for training a cadre of L3 capable CD and RRs, over and above the requirements of the normal CD and RC assessments.
- ii. All staff should be fully sensitised to L3 procedures and consequences as required in the SOP. Some suggestions are:
 - * Circulate a two-page brief on the SOP requirements (a 'popular' version) for L3 Crisis should be circulated to all staff and external recruits.

⁶ The review team was informed that there were no avenues for conveying their feelings and impressions to CO leadership as no management meetings were convened during the first three months after the typhoon.

⁷ Recognising that counter factuals are hard to prove, it is possible that the team leaders from the other programmes would have resisted, whatever the case. The habit of working in silos was simply too deeply ingrained. Furthermore at least one senior national programmes staff insisted that the "downstream" involved in crisis response was not UNDP business and by implication, was beneath the attention of serious programme staff.

- * Undertake regular simulations of disaster responses in countries that are prone to major hazards. [A step-aside policy is unlikely to be productive in regard to national staff. Therefore the expected staff behaviour in crisis situations should be drilled into all staff, which is another reason for simulations].
 - * More attention should be paid at both HQ and Country Office levels to preparing both sides for the radical (even if temporary) change in the dynamics of the CO, starting with initiating the COCRT.⁸
 - * It should be clear and stated without embarrassment that UNDP's tradition of endless consultation and discussions do not apply in times of L3 crises.
- iii. SURGE support should include vital operations assistance, not just programme experts. L3 situations also call for experienced G-6 and G-7 level staff that can help with day-to-day administrative tasks, work on budgets, help with reversals, prepare quick project documents, and help with the logistical demands of a large SURGE team.
 - iv. All SURGE deployees should be given a half-day crash course on the country's cultural and programme context. In the case of external staff or relatively new UNDP staff, training should have a module on UNDP procedures.
 - v. A staff health and welfare counsellor should be included in the SURGE team. She or he will help to keep morale high in situations of extreme stress and trauma.

IV. Programmatic Response

4.1 Actions

Programme Design

As indicated above, the SURGE planning team had produced a work plan in December 2013 that included an indicative multi-year framework for responding to Yolanda. The SURGE core team, led by the SRC, produced the fuller Typhoon Recovery and Resilience in the Visayas (TRRV) document in January 2014, building on the earlier SURGE Plan framework document. The TRRV contributes to the Government's Yolanda Recovery and Rehabilitation Programme (TYRP). Five geographical areas were identified– Tacloban, Guiuan, Ormoc, Roxas and northern Cebu for the implementation of the activities. The programme was seen as a unique opportunity for UNDP Philippines to project the organization's resilience agenda in line with the new Strategic Plan. It was also understood that the mobilisation for an L3 crisis presents an opportunity to better position UNDP programmatically and strategically and raise its profile and visibility.

The three-year TRRV programme framework has three thematic pillars. Under the Governance pillar, it will support coordination arrangements such as the Recovery Resource Centres (RRCs)

⁸ Unaware they were kicking at an open door, national staff insisted on the engagement of CO programme and operations units in the capacity mapping and decision making regarding SURGE advisers. [In the words of one interviewee, "the CO should be involved, even lead in TOR development and selection of appropriate experts. And experts should not simply arrive without TORs"]. The letter is there in the SOP, but the spirit was not apparent on the ground.

in the five programming hubs to restore the operational capacity of Local Government Units (LGUs) to manage recovery efforts. The livelihood programme will focus on restoring livelihoods by helping to rebuild lives through immediate Cash for Work (CfW) for debris clearance activities. It also integrates a longer-term approach to sustainable livelihoods is that will support market development by restoring value chain and enterprise development. The Disaster Risk Reduction and Sustainable Environment pillar will focus on improving early warning systems, emergency preparedness and response capacities in the Visayas, and the mainstreaming of disaster risk reduction in development planning.

The TRRV was budgeted at approximately \$65 million. A proportion of the \$5.1 million received from BCPR was expected to serve as start-up funding for the programme, while resources were mobilized from various sources.

Programme implementation

To date, the programme has supported activities such as the purchase of heavy equipment for debris clearance and demolition of structurally unsafe buildings. It has also supported Cash for work (CfW) projects, including for clearing temporary disaster debris dumps. Technical experts in DRR and Waste Management were deployed to help manage this process on the ground. UNDP also facilitated the provision of equipment to help restore physical resources of LGUs such as generators, farm equipment and solar lanterns.

Additionally UNDP has worked at the municipal level with agencies and partners, such as WHO, UNICEF, ILO, Red Cross, Medecins Sans Frontieres (MSF), Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB), Médicos del Mundo and Catholic Relief Services (CRS), to provide essential municipal and medical waste collection support, as LGUs lacked vehicles and funds during the transition. UNDP also helped with rehabilitating infrastructure damaged/impacted by debris clearance, especially municipal dumpsites, and rebuilding the waste management capacity of the LGUs.

UN and national government partners applauded UNDP's engagement in debris clearance and waste management as critical to the early response phase. Several hundreds of thousands of cubic meters of disaster debris were cleared, vital infrastructure restored within days after the disaster was undertaken. This allowed quick access to humanitarian agencies to key areas.

Short-term employment was provided through CfW for 8,200 persons in 15 municipalities and two cities. This aided in the restoration of basic public facilities and infrastructure, while generating a critical inflow of cash to revive local economy.

Programme management

The minutes of the 22 November 2013 meeting of the CO staff with the RBAP Director indicate that the bureau management decided that the CD should remain in charge of day-to-day programme management while the SRC was responsible for the overall response to Haiyan Typhoon. However, despite this division of labour, it appears that there was still confusion among the CO staff about who was really in charge of the response process given that both the CD and SRC were attending donor meetings and offering differing views. This put UNDP's leadership in question at a time when it was key to be seen as moving cohesively and swiftly. In the face of the continuing confusion among the CO staff about this matter, the RR issued a memorandum ostensibly to clarify the respective roles of the CD and the SRC on 2 December 2013. The

memorandum reiterated that the SRC was in charge of the recovery response and the CD in charge of the regular programme and it instructed the CD and SRC to “define and agree on ways to work with the programme and operations sections during the three months. Unfortunately the confusion remained, as no meeting between the CD and SRC took place, until the CD finally departed in mid-February 2014 (about three months from the onset of Typhoon Haiyan).

4.2 Findings

Programme Design and Implementation

There was a divergence between the planned programme intervention and what actually happened in the ground. UNDP budgeted approximately \$65 million and provided seed capital of \$5 million. The expectation was that resources would be mobilized in the first 3 months. But, as discussed in the Resource Mobilization section, UNDP was not positioned to raise this amount of money for various reasons, including the tension between the CD and the SRC.

There was also a measure of disconnect between staff on the field and in Manila on the TRRV’s programmatic vision. In particular, the technical team on the ground seemed not to have fully understood the strategic vision underlying the TRRV, with its multi sectoral orientation. The focus on the ground was keenly focused on the discrete activities of debris clearance, waste management and cash for work, and could not leverage on the broader strategic vision.

Programmatically, the country office was structured vertically under four major themes: Poverty Reduction, Energy and Environment, Crisis Prevention and Recovery (CPR) and Democratic Governance. It was noted by the SURGE Planning team that there was no tradition of inter-pillar collaboration and units functioned predominantly in silos. In the context of Yolanda, programme staff simply assumed that the CPR team would manage the crisis response and recovery programme as usual. The SRC made several attempts to involve the other programme teams in supporting the Yolanda Recovery Plan but in view of the heavy tension between SRC and CD, the working environment on the ground was simply not positive.

One other reason for the lack of engagement from the other programme units seems to be the feeling that although Haiyan Typhoon was a national crisis, it was concentrated in specific geographical locations and therefore did not merit a complete organisation-wide involvement, especially when they had been instructed that on-going work in Environment and Governance was important and was not expected to be put on hold.

In consequence, neither the original SURGE plan nor the TRRV was able to draw on the technical support of three of the four programme units. The programmes could not leverage the potential complementarity between the governance, climate change adaptation, poverty reduction and the CPR agendas. The Environment team, for instance, had ongoing work on resilience and disaster risk management that complements the areas of focus outlined in the TRRV. It also had a sizeable project staff, some of which could have provided technical assistance to the programme. Similarly, the Governance Unit had an extensive network that included most of the LGUs, and could have been used to support Yolanda Recovery Programme (YRP) initiatives.

In the end, the TRRV was anchored solely within the Conflict Prevention and Recovery (CPR) Unit. Although it has wide experience in crisis management, response and recovery, the CPR unit

is quite small and already over-burdened with on-going responsibilities related to the Bohol Earthquake, Pablo Typhoon and the Mindanao peace process.

In its debris clearance and waste management activities, UNDP found itself in the ironic situation of being a beneficiary of UNICEF generosity. That Agency had met 120 percent of its resource mobilization target and was willing to finance some debris clearance and waste management activities provided they could be tailored to UNICEF priorities. It is through such opportunism that UNDP has been carrying on with implementation of the TRRV programme. In effect, priorities are turning out to be those for which funding can be found.

The ERCs hired at the field level did not seem to have the required understanding or skills to position UNDP strongly on ERL. The consultants that came in after the UNDP staff who served as ERA and ERCC were not as successful in cluster coordination. Moreover, as the review team was told on several occasions, UNDP did not comply with the expected firewall between its ER coordination role, and its ER programming role. Apparently, UNDP programme staff was told to stay away from ER cluster-related tasks, and focus on the ER programme. In addition, consultants hired to take care of cluster coordination got drawn into programme work. The consequence was that UNDP's credibility as a leader of ER cluster was put in question.

UN and Humanitarian agency partners on the ground and at the national level indicated that UNDP's SRCs could not be based full time in the field, given important meetings with government and donors that were taking place in Manila. The resulting gap in decision making leadership at the field level, and lack of integration of procedures from Manila to field level left the field staff without necessary guidance. Unfortunately, a dedicated field manager that had been hired within the first ten days of the disaster was not effective and was eventually asked to resign.

Programme Management

The SRC changed three times in seven months. The first two stayed about three months each and the last about six weeks. The second SRC arrived about the same time as the new CD. They noted that the sum of expenditures and firm commitments exceeded the resources available. (There was no discussion yet with UNICEF about a contribution and Japan's second contribution was still being discussed). Promises had been made, in the frenetic environment of the first three months, to local government authorities, and some of them are still expecting fulfillment. Activities had been initiated against funds that had not materialized. At this point, to reassert compliance with expenditure management and planning controls, the CO was forced to stop activities in order to assess levels of funding and expenditure.

There were accordingly no resources immediately available to pay for a national or international Programme Manager. The office therefore requested BCPR to extend the second SRC. While BCPR agreed exceptionally to fund a three-month extension, the releasing office only agreed to a one month. The CO decided at this point to recruit a national officer for 12 months. But, anticipating that it would take two months to fill the position, the third SRC was brought in for about six weeks to fill the gap. The repeated change of project managers created problems, which, perhaps, could have been anticipated and provision made in the original SURGE budget for the recruitment of a 12-month position in the expectation that the cost would be recovered from resources mobilised. Each turnover generated a significant loss of momentum in work on the ground, loss of institutional memory, a loss of good relations developed with partners, and a delay

in consolidating and building on the gains made in the early response phase. This impacted both work and morale on the ground.

Winding down SURGE

The dynamics between the SURGE team and national programme team saw some tension. This is not a new problem in UNDP, although it seemed particularly pronounced in this CO, where the national staff may have felt displaced and disempowered, given the overwhelming number of SURGE members and the lack of collaboration between the two groups. The CO staff also raised issues regarding the experience and contextual knowledge of some of the experts from the SURGE planning team to the response and recovery teams on the ground.

Nonetheless, it was felt that the departure of SURGE team members was too sudden, and done without a phase-out plan to also ensure a smooth handover of the on-going and upcoming work. It seems that the momentum generated by the SURGE team on the ground was lost after their departure and considerable effort and time had to be invested in re-initiating these activities. In the judgement of the review team, a better integration of the CO team and the SURGE team from the very beginning may have anticipated and addressed this challenge better.⁹

The CPR unit has been over stretched in leading on implementing the TRRV programme following the SURGE drawdown, given that it was already managing on-going work on the Mindanao Peace Process, Bohol Earthquake and Pablo Typhoon and did not have the programmatic support of the other programme units.

4.3 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

- i. While a disaster such as Haiyan Typhoon may not be geographically a national crisis, when it is a L3 level crisis, there should be a country office-wide response and the involvement of all staff in managing the crisis for at least the first month should be mandatory. The senior CO management should be required to ensure this CO-wide response.
- ii. Debris clearance and waste management have been identified as UNDP ‘Signature Products’ and should be marketed as part of the overall ER package. [In the process of mobilising resources in the flash appeal, debris clearance and waste management appear to have been projected as ends in themselves. Projecting them more effectively in a package presented as focused on the quality of lives saved and sustained may have opened some space for positioning early recovery better.]
- iii. UNDP should educate field level hires on the nature of the organisation’s work in humanitarian. They should not be put in situations where they are expected to interpret UNDP’s mandate and may misrepresent it.
- iv. The organisation’s decisions about the scope and substance of involvement in an L3 crisis should be conveyed in a ‘little (UNDP) blue book’ that outlines, in simple language, the link between early response and ER so that donors understand better UNDP roles in

⁹ The loss of momentum is probably not all bad, as it provided necessary space for reflection on what priorities should be going forward, in the light of resource constraints.

disaster (and post conflict) situations. The contents of the book should be internalised by all staff and all must speak from the same script. The message should also be conveyed unequivocally to partners, to avoid UNDP becoming confined to the activity of debris clearance.

V. Operational Response

5.1. Actions

Procurement

Flights to the affected sites were suspended for the first 7 days because the airports were not operational. Once the airport became operational, it was overwhelmed with affected families, government and humanitarian personnel trying to reach the affected areas. Using the services of the United Nations Humanitarian Air Service UNHAS proved to be very challenging because of bureaucratic procedures and long waiting queues. The procurement unit booked and bought tickets on the same day of the flights being resumed without waiting for travel authorization/approved requisition. Acting quickly was imperative as tickets were being purchased at a very rapid rate.

Authorized to sign contracts up to \$30,000, the Team Leader for Procurement and Administrative Services (PAS) flew to Tacloban, the hardest hit site, as soon as flights became open, to issue Individual Contracts to personnel already on the site, sign Long-Term Agreements (LTAs) directly to heavy equipment service providers supporting the cash-for-work activities, sign lease agreements for staff accommodation and warehouse, negotiate with hotel owner to allow UNDP to use their function rooms as UNDP project office, and enter into ‘send-bill’ arrangements with fuel suppliers to jumpstart activities on the ground.

Literally the day after the disaster, the CPR and procurement units started sourcing personal protective equipment (PPEs), hand tools and UNDP visibility materials for urgent debris-clearing work.¹⁰ The CO moved quickly to establish UNDP presence in the Typhoon-affected locations. In the process, the unit found it necessary to by-pass some procurement policies, such as convening CAP Committee reviews for purchases exceeding \$50,000, and advertising internationally for goods exceeding \$100,000 in value.¹¹ The procurement unit duly prepared Notes-to-File (NTFs) to explain the need for such unorthodox measures. The NTFs were approved by, the SRC, and were valid for the entire fast-track period of 6 months.

¹⁰ On the second day it was not certain what would be needed for Yolanda, but the CO had a general idea that PPEs, equipment and hand tools for debris clearing were likely to be the same as those procured during Typhoon Pablo in 2012, and those that had been procured (or were still being procured) for the Bohol earthquake. To jumpstart the response, the office diverted a significant number of PPEs, hand tools and visibility materials intended for the Bohol response. The Yolanda response was borrowing in more ways than one from other projects. Ironically, the chronic disaster situation of the country ensured an unusual degree of readiness to respond to Yolanda.

¹¹ There seemed to be no point in sending quote requests to vendors who did not have goods in stock, as they would not be able to supply at the earliest. All vendors were given only one day to submit their quantities available, price and delivery offers, and the shortest delivery time was used as the primary criterion in deciding. To be clear, while the NTFs explained the need to by pass regulations it was still necessary to undertake the required reviews post facto.

There being no project in Atlas at the time against which to charge goods, the procurement unit resorted to the issuance of manual purchase orders (PO) as the only way to ensure the timely delivery of goods on the ground during that critical time, despite the knowledge that this is a deviation from procurement policy and internal controls.¹² The manual POs were duly entered in Atlas at the end of November 2013. Many of the expenditures were charged to 11888 (interest accumulated on cost sharing) while others were charged to the CPR unit's Projects on Mindanao and Bohol Earthquake Recovery because of the availability of unspent funds in those projects. These charges were made in the understanding that reversals would be undertaken at a later date when the funds for Yolanda will be created in Atlas. Because of the delayed availability of funds, POs had to be issued again in December 2013 with the approval of the SRC.

It was difficult to prepare a procurement plan in the middle of the disaster response. First, the magnitude, pace and logistical limitations of implementation used up all available staff time. Second the situation was one of "moving targets" where, for example, the targets for CFW workers kept increasing, even in the face of continued funding uncertainty. Accordingly, a procurement plan was prepared post facto by taking note of all the requests received from the CPR unit. The same matrix was used for monitoring delivery of goods ordered and received.

Logistics

OCHA was appointed by the UNRC/HC as the focal agency for obtaining entry visas to the country. All UN missions and UNDP SURGE personnel seeking entry were coursed through OCHA and thus, were given preferential treatment by the Department of Foreign Affairs (DFA) as humanitarian workers. This cut the visa application process from 7-10 working days, to only 1-2 days. With the large number of people, UNDP was competing with all other UN Agencies and humanitarian organisations to find accommodation for the SURGE personnel arriving in Manila and the affected sites.

The procurement unit diverted vehicle LTAs meant to serve other projects to the Typhoon affected sites. Car rentals from Mindanao were loaded with non-perishable food and water, driven by land and sailed through barge to get to the sites where they were needed. The procurement unit also took advantage of the existing UNICEF LTAs to bring other goods to the sites. The global UNDP LTA with Kuehne-Nagel for forwarding services proved to be too expensive and incapable of handling the required volume of goods within tight deadlines. During the first three months, humanitarian organisations and government agencies were all deploying goods to the affected sites, creating a queue of trucks in ports often up to 50 kilometres long. UNDP worked with the Philippine military to track its shipments, until they arrived at the port of destination, not only for purposes of avoiding long inspection at multiple checkpoints en route, but also to avoid piracy and looting which were feared as a result of delayed humanitarian assistance to the affected provinces.

In order to ensure continuous supply, UNDP rented warehouses in Manila, Tacloban, Guiuan and Roxas within the first month of the Typhoon, and posted an Inventory Assistant in Manila to

¹² A CERF contribution of \$1.5 million was approved on 15 November and made available on 21 November. On receiving approval of these funds, CPRU created the project in ATLAS under award ID 77295, which was intended to house all anticipated funds for ER for Yolanda areas. (In the interim 6 days, Yolanda-related expenses were being charged to the FASTRAC project for Mindanao—reversals to be done later). The CERF funds were used up by around mid-December, given the sheer volume and speed at which the debris clearing had to be done. Japan's first contribution (proposal approved in the third week of November) came in on 31 December.

monitor the stock and movements of PPEs, hand tools and other equipment stored in the warehouses and ensure goods were deployed to the four warehouses in time. Two months later, the UNDP Project Office in Tacloban hired an additional Inventory Assistant for Tacloban as the volume of goods there grew.

5.2 Findings

From November 8 November 2013 to 31 May 2014, the total PO value amounted to approximately \$6.2 million, implying a daily average of over \$30,000. UNDP Fast Track measures, which provide a threshold of only \$300,000 for the entire period of a crisis, were inadequate to handle the expenditure rate and volume. Realising this, the requested UNDP Headquarters for an increase of this threshold to \$500,000. The request was denied for lack of a procurement plan.

Staff on the ground needed immediately basic infrastructure, and some essential goods and services to be able to function and deliver on the ground. Access to cash would have greatly facilitated this. Furthermore, given the massive scale of the devastation, it required more than the five people allowable for recruitment without due to process under the SOP to manage the entire operations.

Our informants suggested that if UNDP is to play such a major role in debris clearance and waste management, it should equip itself operationally with the appropriate tools, processes and systems to respond to an L-3 crisis with an organisational efficiency, agility and swiftness comparable to those of the humanitarian agencies. Despite the CO's best efforts, delays in procurement were experienced from the beginning. UNDP did not have in place the necessary systems, partners and documentation in place for urgent procurement. For instance the lack of easy access to pre-certified vendors of debris clearing equipment meant that UNDP had to scramble to find available vendors at a time of crisis. The review team was informed that for a 3-month period, cash-for-work operations needed about 60,000 personal protective equipment (PPE) sets (dust mask, hand gloves, steel toe boots and hard hats), bearing UNDP logos. Some delays in purchase of goods were also due to the irregular flow of funds to the project. In the first instance there was no firm overall budget, as resources were still being mobilised.¹³

Furthermore there was typically a lag between commitment and disbursement of funds. For instance, as explained under resource mobilisation, BCPR committed \$5 million in the first week as seed funding for the Yolanda response, but the bulk of the funds were disbursed and received by the CO only in March. An initial amount of USD \$550,000 of the committed USD \$5 million was disbursed by BCPR in early December 2013. Similarly, Japan was the first donor to have agreed to fund certain activities in late November 2013 but the funds were made available to the CO only in late December 2013

UNDP policy requires that the purchase of debris clearance equipment and other expenditures be booked through ATLAS (with programme units raising requisitions, obtaining requisition approvals, and buyers creating and getting approval for the POs). But the operations team was limited in capacity, relative to the magnitude of priority tasks under very compressed timelines.

¹³ It is only fair to note that there was an initial CERF fund of \$ 1.5M, with AWP and set up in ATLAS less than two weeks after the disaster.

This slowed the process of ATLAS entry. At the same time, procurements were charged against a myriad of project heads as there was no bulk money on hand dedicated to the Typhoon response. In consequence, it was hard to reconcile expenditures with available funds. This forced UNDP CO management to halt all new purchases for a few weeks in February 2014 in order to clear the accounts, clean up the records, and determine exactly how much more is available for the typhoon recovery project to spend in the succeeding months.

When funds became available under the TRRV project, the actual amount to be reversed against each ATLAS project was not clear. Consequently the reversals have been quite a challenging task. As of June 2014, the Operations Manager, with assistance from the CPR Unit is still in the process of cleaning reversals.

5.3 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

i. Revise Fast-Track Procedures

UNDP should provide for the following recommendations to be enabled immediately after a L-3 crisis situation is declared, without the requirement for detailed initial documentation.

- Raise the fast track cash authorization limit to one million dollars;
- Allow the use of direct contracting for all purchases below the CO's Delegated Procurement Authority (DPA) during the first month following the occurrence of the crisis/disaster;
- Waive the need for international advertisement of procurement cases exceeding US\$ 100,000 – whether as a single contract/PO or as an accumulation of multiple contract/POs, within the first three months following the occurrence of the crisis;
- Allow the post-facto submission for CAP review of procurement cases exceeding US\$ 50,000 – whether as a single contract/PO or as an accumulation of multiple contract/POs – during the first three months following the occurrence of the crisis;
- In issuing Service Contracts (SC), waive the normal requirements (such as advertising for ten days, shortlisting, interviews and written examination), which may take up to two months. [Too long a period would cause UNDP to lose potential recruits to other UN and humanitarian agencies that are moving faster to hire the best people.]¹⁴
- Develop LTAs for supplies and services that UNDP is likely to require in humanitarian situations (such as PPEs and hand tools).

ii Logistic support

¹⁴ Area Managers were hired within 2 weeks of the disaster. There is no reason this cannot be the regular practice. It could even be possible in less time than two weeks and the practice could also be extended to other field staff.

- Enter into LTAs with global partner banks for the physical delivery of cash in local currency wherever a UNDP CO needs them, and ensure that local counterparts of those banks will fully implement their obligations in the agreement.¹⁵
- Arrange for LTAs related to debris clearing and waste management services, with standard specifications/TORs for the various aspects, such as treatment, recycling and incineration.
- Establish a UNDP Warehouse in the country or, at least, the region. [If UNDP is to maintain its muscular involvement in the humanitarian phase of crisis response, it needs a warehouse where the commonly procured goods during emergency may be stored].
- Establish a checklist of minimum requirements for setting up a field office in major crisis situations, (taking into consideration various critical factors such as access to energy, water and connectivity).

VI. UN and Interagency Coordination

6.1 Actions

As typically happens in crisis situation of such magnitude, the HC's office was overwhelmed with SURGE teams from all the agencies, with many OCHA staff working out of her office. International first responders massively outnumbered national staff members. She was totally engaged in meetings UN agencies, Government and donors, and traveling to the field and accompanying high level officials from UN agencies. The HC was duly invested with "empowered leadership" in accordance with the decisions of the IASC Principals on leading coordination. It seemed to the review team however, that she was not given the level of support that empowerment suggests.¹⁶

The UNDP CPR Practice Leader based in Bangkok was on the ground within 24 hours to support the HC, in working with the many government entities involved in the crisis response. He also provided support in negotiations with the Government, the World Bank and Asian Development Bank (ADB) on the Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA). On 10 November an Early Recovery Adviser (ERA) was deployed as part of the Inter Agency Rapid Response Mechanism (IARRM) from the Global Cluster standing capacity in Geneva upon request of the HC. The initial timeframe

¹⁵ The current corporate LTA of OFRM/BOM with Citibank for the delivery of US dollars proved ineffective on the ground in Philippines, because the local Citibank branch refused to honour the obligations in the said LTA.

¹⁶ The concept note on empowered HC leadership is long on the duties and responsibilities of the HC, but silent on accompanying support. For instance the major section on "What is needed for the HC to be empowered and effective" merely identifies such tasks as leading advocacy and relationships with national authorities, donor and other partners; ensuring adequate information and monitoring of the response; and leading overall cluster coordination and setting priorities and planning. But it makes no reference to the kind of support that an HC might require. It is also the case that HCs have no authority over OCHA staff. Consequently, while her office was chuck full of OCHA people, none of them was actually accountable directly to her.

of deployment was two weeks, but upon assessment of the coordination context, needs and existing capacity the ERA was extended for four weeks. The main task of the ERA was to support the HC and provide interagency ER support through the HCT. On the request of the ERC and the HC the ERA established a sub-group under the HCT, which dealt with sustainable solutions. The group consisted of HCT members working on bridging the humanitarian response into recovery and development – creating an agenda for early recovery and recovery issues from the onset of the crisis. The ERA also supported the HC in negotiations with various partners in the PDNA process, and in efforts to link the government’s Yolanda Recovery and Rehabilitation Plan and the Strategic Response Plan. Together with CPR Regional Practice Coordinator, the ERA also facilitated the UN agencies’ initial discussions on the PDNA. Another important element of support provided by UNDP to the HC was the provision of two SURGE experts to handle protocol and workflow management.

An Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator (ERCC) was also deployed at the same time as the ERA to set up the Early Recovery Cluster and coordinate the contributions of cluster members working on early recovery interventions. The ERCC helped develop the early recovery cluster response plan, which was to feed into the overall Strategic Response Plan (SRP) for the crisis. (The ERCC was also requested to contribute directly to the SRP. The ERCC ensured integration of early recovery in the Multi Sector Inter-Cluster Rapid Assessment (MIRA I and MIRA II) and established basic information management of the cluster, such as populating the Who What Where (WWW) overviews and providing inputs to situation reports. The ERCC also ensured coordination with other clusters, to ensure ER integration.

Early Recovery Cluster Coordination and Inter Cluster Coordination

Philippines was in the usual situation of having two cluster systems. A National Disaster Coordinating Council (NDCC) circular of May 10 2007¹⁷ announced its intention to adopt the IASC Cluster Approach with the objective of aligning it with the existing government coordination structures and response mechanisms. This circular, identified 11 clusters with Early Recovery and Livelihoods being separate clusters. The Government lead for the ER Cluster is the Office of Civil Defence (OCD) with UNDP as Counterpart. For the Livelihoods Cluster, Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) is the government lead with ILO as counterpart. ILO preferred this system because it was of the view that ER and Livelihoods were programmatically and operationally distinct issues.

Four weeks into the response, the Principals instructed that the ER Cluster and the Livelihoods Clusters merge. UNDP as Cluster Lead Agency and the ERCC supported this process and worked twith ILO, the HC and Deputy HC to facilitate the merger. The ERCC drafted the first joint Strategic Plan for the Early Recovery & Livelihoods Cluster. However, as discussed in the findings section, the collaboration between UNDP and ILO was not smooth and challenges remained on which agency is better positioned to lead the ERL cluster.

¹⁷ NDCC Circular No 5 s-2007 Titled *The Institutionalization of the Cluster Approach in the Philippine Disaster Management System, Designation of Cluster Leads and their Terms of Reference at the National, Regional, and Provincial level* (Can be accessed online at http://bvpad.indeci.gob.pe/download/eventos/CD_RPNCCP/2008-10-20%20a1%2022)

The ERCC strengthened the Early Recovery Cluster in Manila for Typhoon Yolanda response coordination, meeting with close to 40 partners (UN, I/NGOs, donors) on a weekly basis to discuss strategies, share information and coordinate ER issues. The issues included debris clearing, cash for work, support to local government, community restoration, disaster management and disaster risk reduction (DRR). A Strategic Advisory Group for the Cluster was also established consisting of Adventist Development and Relief Agency (ADRA), FAO, UN Habitat, Agency for Technical Cooperation and Development (ACTED), UNESCO, UNDP & the ERCC). The ERCC also represented the ER cluster in the Humanitarian Country Team, at donor briefings and coordinated with all 11 clusters in the Inter-Cluster Coordination Group. Additionally, she coordinated very closely with the Shelter Cluster, the Logistics Cluster, the Livelihoods Cluster, the WASH Cluster, and the Cash Working Group (including the Agriculture cluster). The ERCC also facilitated the ER cluster contribution to the Strategic Response Plan, coordinating projects from 13 different UN agencies and NGOs for submission to the revised appeals process.

6.2 Findings

ER coordination

Some informants suggested that UNDP's coordination of the Early Recovery and Livelihoods (ERL) cluster could have been stronger if the strong leadership and expertise provided by the first ERA and ERCC had been maintained. Following their departure coordination leadership appears to have declined radically, with a rapid turnover of cluster coordinators, and a significant lack of training and experience on the part of some field cluster coordinators.

Not surprisingly, communication between Manila and the affected areas was very difficult in the initial response period. There was no time for the Manila-based ERCC to travel to the field due to the extremely tight deadlines and numerous deliverables in Manila. A regular line of coordination between Manila and coordination hubs was not established. Information sharing was ad hoc, through sporadic SMS, emails, reports from UNDP staff and other agency.

The disconnect between the field level and Manila on cluster coordination work was aggravated by a lack of attention from the SRC. He seems to have distanced himself from cluster coordination in Manila, as he had to attend important meetings with donors, government counterparts and UN agencies. He spent a significant part of his time in the affected areas, but his focus remained sharply on early response to the crisis.

OCHA's high focus on and demand for information management and communication products to serve the inter-agency information management system also appears to have taken a toll on coordination during the first 6-12 weeks. The excessive emphasis on products and deadlines rather than seeing the Humanitarian Programme Cycle as a continuous strategic process, coupled with weak UNDP cluster coordination capacity on the ground continue to challenge the coordination process.

The review team observed that cluster coordination was weak in Tacloban, Roxas and the other hubs. As indicated in table 6.1 below, there were several cluster coordinators in place but, as several interlocutors, including UNDP's ERCC confirmed, they seemed to have been drawn into UNDP's programme work and away from the coordination of cluster team members. UNDP senior

management was also concerned that most of the ER coordinators at the hubs were lacked relevant knowledge and experience. Early Recovery coordination at field level should have been strengthened as the response moved forward and coordination hubs and human capacity were set up.

Table 6.1: UNDP ER Coordination Support (circa June 2014).

Location	Coordinator
Tacloban	1international 1national *1national
Guiuan	1national
Ormoc	1national
Roxas	1international (SCF/UNDP)
UNDP Support to Local Government Coordination	4 international advisors - seconded from Australia to UNDP Between 20 and 25 advisors seconded to municipalities (under recruitment)
UNDP Coordination Support to the Office of the Presidential Adviser (OPARR)	3international advisors 7 national advisors

**Information Manager*

UNDP programmatic leadership of ERL Cluster

Most commentators applauded UNDP's role in debris clearance, which provided the major humanitarian agencies early access to people in need. On the ground, the local government authorities warmly embraced and loudly commended UNDP in this role. Beyond this ostensibly lifesaving activity, however, UNDP's role seemed unclear. Even within the UNDP team on the ground there were differences, with some feeling that it should focus on debris clearance and waste management as humanitarian response: period! On the other hand BCPR and experienced UNDP experts were clear that such signature work should, from the perspective of UNDP as a development agency, serve as a hook for mobilising resources for Early Recovery.

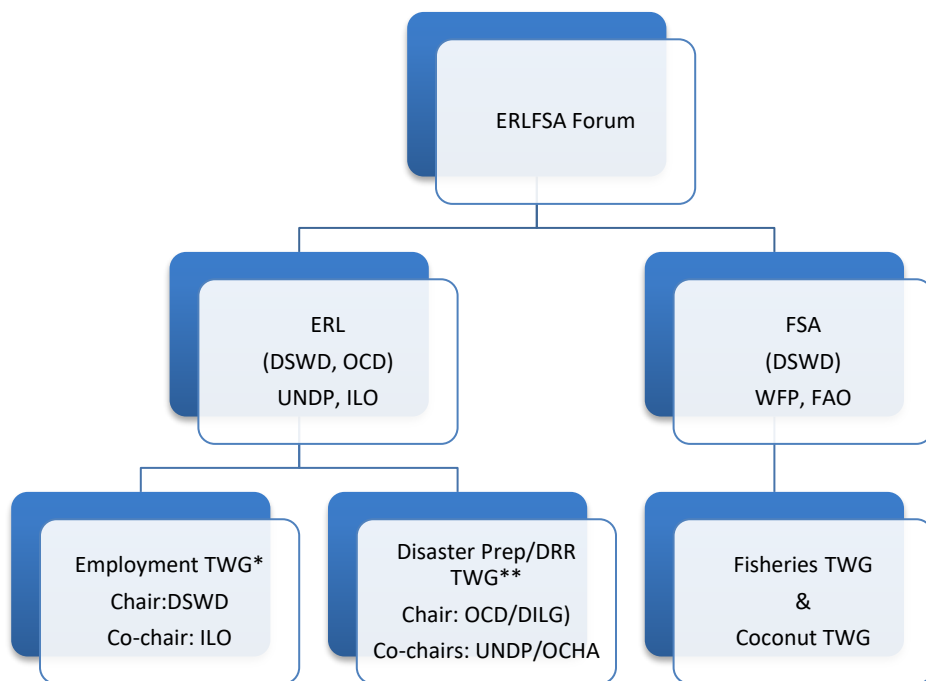
The distinction could be more sharply drawn between UNDP as ER Cluster Lead and UNDP as a substantive player in early recovery and intellectual leader on the transition from the humanitarian phase through recovery to the return to development. UNDP needs to advocate and communicate its normative role in ERL better and unambiguously. To put it in perspective, the roles of UNICEF and WFP in humanitarian situations are clear and unambiguous. The agencies fully understand what is expected from them and donors and other partners understand from the start what these agencies can do and the level of financial and coordination support they require from them. The same cannot be said about UNDP at this stage.

The UNDP and ILO collaboration in leading the ERL cluster was poor due to a disagreement between them on which agency is better positioned thematically to lead the cluster. ILO felt that their global mandate and existing work on the ground was on livelihoods, making it better positioned to lead on Livelihoods component. However, UNDP felt that given its mandate on ER to which livelihoods is intrinsic, it was better positioned to lead of the ERL cluster.¹⁸ The wide perception of poor performance on ERL cluster coordination stemmed partly from this disagreement. The merging of ER and Livelihoods without clarity on how the ER component is distinct from livelihoods, and conversely how they complement each other, led to some duplication of efforts. Given this ambiguity, their joint leadership did not work smoothly, although collaboration has now improved according to both sides.

In April 2014, the HC announced the introduction of the Early Recovery, Livelihoods, Food Security and Agriculture Forum (ERLFSFA) to ensure that the work of the two clusters and their respective Technical Working Groups (TWGs) is properly interfaced and synchronized with national and local government plans and actions, and with the private sector (Figure XX). The forum meets at least once a month to provide strategic and policy guidance to the cluster implementation agendas, and to discuss cross cutting issues. The Country Director of UNDP facilitates the forum, with membership comprised of the Heads of FAO, ILO, WFP, UNHABITAT and three representatives of the Philippine INGO Network. As indicated in the diagram, government entities chair the TWGs. ILO co-chairs the employment thematic working group that deals with standards and employment generation, while UNDP and OCHA jointly co-chair the TWG for disaster preparedness and disaster risk coordination. This group deals with LGU capacity development and hazard mapping.

¹⁸ Some UNDP staff asserted that, not being a member of the IASC, ILO lacked understanding of the Transformative Agenda and how the cluster works. Be that as it may, the review team also felt that the substantive understanding of early recovery and livelihoods on the part of those who spoke for UNDP on the subject could have been stronger.

Fig. 6.1: Coordination Arrangements for Early Recovery, and Food Security and Agriculture (April 2014)



- Key: DSWD = Dept. of Social Welfare and Development
 DILG = Dept. of Interior and Local Government
 OCD = Office of Civil Defence
 LGU = Local Government Unit
- Notes: * Addresses standards and norms; employment generation
 ** Addresses Capacity development for LGUs; hazard mapping

6.3 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

- i. The HC should be given strong and consistent support for at least the first six months to be effectively empowered. Such support could comprise: a Strategic Planning Advisor, an Early Recovery Advisor, a Protocol Officer and a Special Assistant to manage the HC's agenda.
- ii. The IASC Principals should review the concept note on empowered leadership and determine how best to give HCs substantive authority corresponding to the responsibility placed on them in L3 situations.
- iii. At the corporate level UNDP and ILO should work out operational and policy guidelines on the ERL that will clarify substantively areas of comparative advantage between the two organisations in the early recovery domain. Livelihoods being a part of how ER, it is essential for areas of complementarity to be identified. Clear roles and responsibilities including a division of labour between UNDP and ILO have to be developed so that both agencies can work in collaboration rather than in competition with each other.
- iv. At the country level, separating ER and livelihoods appears to have undermined the coherence of the response. It is essential that the HC lead discussions with government on resolving this dichotomy. In the meantime, the ERL cluster coordination with Government should be kept as strong as possible.
- v. Information management officers should be deployed at the same time as the ERA and the Early Recovery cluster coordinator as a team. This will support the high demand for information products from OCHA.
- vi. As cluster coordination is a labour intensive task, UNDP should invest the necessary resources on dedicated cluster coordination. More attention should be paid to ensuring that ER cluster coordinators in the field and at the central level understand that their substantive role is coordination, not UNDP work within the cluster.
- vii. Experienced, L3-capable and dedicated field coordination capacity should be deployed early on in the response, and UNDP must ensure that the XPRESS roster contains really experienced ER coordinators and advisors who can be deployed quickly in times of disasters. Similar attention must be paid to the credentials of ER cluster coordinators recruited via partners' stand-by by rosters.

VII. UNDP Engagement in the wider planning process of recovery

7.1. Actions

Post-Disaster Needs Assessments, conducted under the leadership of governments, are normally the framework for recovery and reconstruction plans and programmes, and the base document for discussions about international development assistance. There was a difference of opinion regarding the need for a PDNA between the National Economic and Development Authority

(NEDA), which has oversight of the national budget and the Office of Civil Defense, which is in charge of Yolanda recovery efforts. This divergence fed into the long-running substantive and methodological tension between UNDP and the World Bank, in spite of the ‘Joint Declaration on Post-Crisis Assessments and Recovery Planning’ signed by the two organizations and the EU in 2008. Although the declaration committed the agencies to participating using a common approach, UNDP and the World Bank (the EU was not active in Manila) did not have a common approach to engaging with the government. Indeed the two agencies were speaking to different government entities, the UN to the OCD and the World Bank (with ADB) to NEDA.

The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (NDRRMC), under the OCD, leads the preparation of the PDNA. As already indicated, the ERA and the CPR Regional Practice Coordinator facilitated UN agencies’ initial discussions on the PDNA. Although a draft of the PDNA has been completed, it has not yet been submitted officially to the President for approval. Meanwhile OPARR has been working with five clusters to get work moving on the ground. It has, for instance, determined that 200,000 housing units need to be rehabilitated or rebuilt, of which 90 percent are in the pipeline of the National Housing Authority and private sponsors. In early May only about 15,000 had been completed and turned over to beneficiaries. Some progress has also been made in the rehabilitating classrooms, health centers and hospitals.

7.2 Findings

The collaboration on the PDNA between the UN on the one hand and the World Bank and ADB on the other has been challenging. These organizations not have a common approach on engaging with the government. The RAY anchored by NEDA (and supported by the banks) had been published in December 2013 to meet a budget dead line. However it is the PDNA that provides the platform for the recovery plan. The financial figures generated by RAY do not match those of the PDNA, and the discrepancy has put all three agencies in a bad light with the government. The challenges of PDNA is structural and require substantial reflection on how the three actors [EU-WB-UNDP (plus the respective regional development banks)] can act more collaboratively in triggering a PDNA, and adopting a common approach that best serves the host government.

7.3 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

- i. To strengthen Tripartite agreement between EU, WB and UNDP, all three agencies need to re-initiate discussion on a common approach, common SOP and common protocol on PDNA at the country level. The UN would probably be best served if it works under a DOCO umbrella as in the case of the post-conflict needs assessment.
- ii. The HC should approach key external agencies to organise themselves to act jointly in preparation for the next crisis, which is a strong probability in Philippines. This process should also entail putting in place a systems and processes at the country level that will nurture strong collaboration between the UN and the multilateral financial institutions.
- iii. UNDP should include a PDNA technical specialist in its SURGE deployment for L3 disasters. Changes to be made to the current SOP to include PDNA technical specialist as well create a dedicated roster for PDNA specialists.

- iv. In the Philippines, UNDP should provide dedicated support to the government to strengthen comprehensively its mechanisms for managing recovery processes.

VIII. Resource Mobilization

8.1 Actions

The SURGE Planning team led by Chief, Country Support Management Team, BCPR, prepared a three months surge plan that described the required capacity support to the UNDP Philippines Office for an initial period of three months. BCPR provided the sum of \$1 million to support SURGE team members and personnel sourced from BCPR and BOM. The SURGE Plan also included an initial recovery programme for an estimated \$48.5 million to be mobilised. The recovery plan covered four major areas: debris removal through emergency employment, rebuilding governance capacities of the affected local government units, restoring livelihoods of vulnerable communities, and rehabilitating critical community infrastructure and services.

In January 2014 the SURGE Team, under the leadership of the Senior Recovery Coordinator, prepared a three-year programme for Typhoon Recovery and Resilience in the Visayas (TRRV) with a budget of \$64.972 million (approximate value of USD \$65 million), superseding the SURGE Plan. The TRRV document became the framework document for resource mobilisation.

At the first Crisis Board Meeting, BCPR committed USD \$5 million towards the response. The first tranche of \$550,000 was released in the second week of December 2013 to cover the costs of international and local UNVs allowances (the TRRV document had indicated that UNVs be tapped for various project activities), and equipment purchase, including vehicles. The balance was made available in March 2014.¹⁹

BCPR also made \$100,000 available in November 2013 to support the office of the RC. The funds were received against a concept note prepared by the CPR unit. An amount of \$1.5 million was allocated from CERF in mid-November 2013. CPR unit developed a project document by 15 November titled 'Time Critical Debris Management For Affected Areas by Typhoon Haiyan' against which the committed funds were availed. RBAP also made available in November 2013, the sum of \$100,000 from its extra budgetary resources to support the office of the RC and for staffing and personnel costs. DOCO also provided funding to the sum of \$79,227 for staffing and other coordination costs.

¹⁹ There were several reasons for this lag between commitment and release. The review team was informed that BCPR had instructed that donor monies be used first, as the balance of the BCPR funds was intended for early recovery interventions and especially not for CFW. There seemed to be no real rush to prepare the AWP until February 2014, as it became clear that donor monies were not forthcoming as expected. In the process of preparing the AWP in mid-February 2014, the CD and the new SRC asked for a temporary halt to project transactions while the status of funds would be reviewed to establish exactly how much was left for continued operations. The AWP was finally approved by the SRC in the last week of Feb and sent to HQ in the first week of March.

Discussions between and the Government of Japan that had been going for several months before Haiyan Typhoon helped to secure two contributions of \$3.5 million each, yielding \$7 million in total. In the aftermath of Haiyan, the funding was assigned to time critical debris disposal and management. UNICEF provided funding of \$3,485,160 to UNDP, which was received in mid-May 2014. An amount of \$1,000,458 million was secured from the Russian Federation in late December 2013. UNDP also received various smaller sums, from other sources. The resource mobilisation table below shows the levels of funds that were mobilised both from donor partners and within UNDP and the UN against the total TRRV budget of approximately \$65 million.

RESOURCE MOBILIZATION FOR UNDP'S RESPONSE TO TYPHOON HAIYAN UPDATE AS OF 23 MAY 2014				
FUNDING FOR SUPPORT TO TYPHOON RECOVERY AND RESILIENCE IN THE VISAYAS (TRRV)				
Donors	Received contributions in US\$	Timeline	Status	Description of support
CERF	1,500,022	CO confirmed	CO notified on 20 Nov 2013	Debris and emergency employment
Japan	3,500,000	Note verbale dated 21 November 2013	Received by CO on 24 December 2013	Debris and emergency employment
Japan	3,500,000	Letter dated	Received by CO on 15 April 2014	Debris and emergency employment
BCPR	100,000	Letter dated 14 November 2013	Received by CO on November 2013 (At Department level and not Project)	Support to RCO, Recovery Needs Assessment and ER coordination
BCPR	5,000,000	Letter dated 25 November 2013	550,000 received by the CO in 6-Dec-13 Remaining 4,450,000 received by CO in 11 March 2014	TRRV
BCPR SURGE	1,840,537	Nov-13	Provided	3 month SRUGE staffing cost charged to SURGE
CO Projects	274,995	Nov-13	Provided	3 month SRUGE staffing cost charged to SURGE
DOCO	57,524	Email to CO	Received by CO on 6 December 2013	Staffing and coordination work
RBAP	100,000	RBAP email	Transferred to CO XB on 16 November 2013	Management needs (including support to RCO)
Ecuador	500,000	Agreement dated	Received by CO on 11 December 2013	Emergency employment: job creation through debris and solid waste management
Russia	1,000,458	3-Dec-13	Received by CO 27 December 2013	Debris and emergency employment
Philippine Disaster Recovery Foundation	101,477	Agreement dated	Received by CO 20 March 2014	Debris and emergency employment
Kuwait	25,000	Letter dated 10-Jan-14	Received by CO 30 January 2014	Emergency employment: job creation through debris and solid waste management
Botswana	176	Dec-13	Received by CO on 16 January 2014	CO office staff contribution

The World Federation of KSIMC (NGO)	15,000	Agreement dated April 2014	Received by CO 08 May 2014	Emergency employment
UNICEF	3,485,160	Agreement signed April 2014	Received by CO 16 May 2014	Recovery and Resilience
GWA Konno	9,780	Contribution letter accepted by PHL CO 15 May 2014	CO awaiting receipt of funds	Emergency employment
Proceedings Match against Poverty	190,000	Amount confirmed through email 3 June 2014 by Aziyade Poltier-Mutal	CO awaiting receipt of funds	Emergency employment
FIFA	10,000	Agreement dated 4 March 2014	Received by CO on 3 April 2014 and 28 May 2014	Communications
Online Donations	11,747		Received by CO 16 June 2014	
TOTAL RECEIVED FUNDING	21,211,832	BUDGET DEFICIT	43,760,218	

8.2. Findings

The Resource Mobilisation Table indicates that beyond the CERF contribution, the bulk of resources began to be available to the CO from late December 2013. Although BCPR committed \$5 million very rapidly and released a tranche of \$550,000 early in December 2013, it was not until March 2014 that the balance of USD \$4,450,000 was requested. The intention was to preserve these funds for the “real” ER work while donor funding was sought for ostensibly easier to fund activities like CfW. As the flow of these monies was intermittent, activities were being undertaken on the ground for which there was only the expectation that funds would be received, given the urgency of the situation. The activities were indeed covered by resources that became available later, but it made for a messy financial that required later clean up.

The TRRV budget of \$64.972 million remains largely unfunded. Including the funds from UNDP and DOCO, only \$24.887 million has been mobilised to date. Some colleagues suggested that the TRRV budget might have been too ambitious, given that UNDP is not known as a major player in humanitarian response. Others suggested that, given the large amounts of financial assistance that were available in principle, it was more because UNDP was not sufficiently prepared in terms of leadership, organisation and thematic clarity on funding appeal. There seemed to have been no clear strategy on how to engage donors effectively enough to contribute to UNDP’s role in crisis response. The result was that UNDP largely missed out on the window of opportunity during the first two to three months after the disaster during which resources for response and recovery were most likely abundant. In the event, UNDP resource mobilisation became simply one of opportunism.

The AAR team was informed that the ‘Guidelines for Mobilizing Resources in Response to Crisis’, which was finalised in November 2013, was duly used for Typhoon Yolanda response. The guidelines don appear to have been followed substantially, beginning with convening a resource mobilization task force. However, the detailed procedures and processes outlined in the guidelines cannot substitute for a resource mobilization strategy that is tailored specifically to the [Philippines](#). A robust resource mobilisation strategy would have included a donor-mapping database at the CO to facilitate engagement during crisis periods. Without this, it took time to understand where the funding sources were and which donors were most active in the various phases of the response from immediate response to early recovery response.

The challenge of resource mobilization cannot be attributed to a missing resource mobilisation strategy alone. It should be understood in the wider context of the institutional and political framework of an L-3 crisis. The UN humanitarian agencies focus almost exclusively on addressing humanitarian relief and are therefore, institutionally and substantively prepared to act swiftly and with greater precision in their resource mobilisation efforts. These agencies had dedicated resource mobilisation staff immediately reaching out to their donor partners with the required documentation.

The foundation for resource mobilisation in humanitarian emergencies needs to be done before the disaster strikes. UNDP still does not have strong networks with donors in the humanitarian domain. It should develop pre-crisis networks and cultivate these relationships with donor governments and corporations whose Corporate Social Responsibility agendas include recovery

and rehabilitation assistance. Donors appear to have been unwilling to fund UNDP in the humanitarian response phase partly due to a continuing lack of understanding of how ER sits in humanitarian response situations.

Perhaps most important in the Philippines, the confusion in the leadership roles of the Country Director and the Senior Recovery Coordinator heavily aggravated the challenges of mobilising resources. . Both would attend donor meetings, and the absence of a common position between them on various indicated to donors a divided UNDP, and put to question the credibility of UNDP's leadership at a very crucial time. It is important to note also that, as several key informants observed to the review team, many donors had long expressed grave concerns about UNDP's programme leadership in the country.

The fact that UNDP was not as prepared as other agencies to secure funding, shows that there is a clear need to have tailored processes and systems both at the corporate and country level for such crises that have to be already instituted for quick engagement vis-à-vis resource mobilization. A learning-by-doing approach during in a L-3 crisis situation is not favourable for UNDP's reputation and being prepared both programmatically and operationally will help the organization to act quickly and effectively.

8.3 Lessons Learned and Recommendations

- i. The SURGE planning team should include a Resource Mobilization (RM) person who would design a RM strategy as part of the recovery plan and should continue to stay at the CO to lead the actual mobilization work.
- ii. Considering that Philippines is disaster prone, UNDP CO should consider engaging a resource mobilization expert who would manage the organisation's relations with donors on the ground and ensuring UNDP's continuing presence on their radar before disasters strike. This function will work closely with the Partnership Unit in HQ and keep BCPR, RBAP and Partnership unit regularly informed on the levels of funding received from donors and what the funding deficits are. This will allow CO and HQ to assess the area of intervention and level of activities UNDP can support immediately in disasters. A better understanding the funding gaps, will allow UNDP to make informed decisions on mobilizing resources with donors at the corporate level.
- iii. Resource mobilisation calls for the engagement of several departments within UNDP. The approach to RM for crisis response appears to be rather ad hoc and reactive, not strategic. UNDP should prepare a policy that outlines what RM for crisis response entails for UNDP as well as the role of the different units that need to be involved.

Annex I

TOR for ARR Team

A. Background and context

On 8 November 2013, Typhoon Haiyan (locally known as Yolanda) hit the Philippines. The intensity of the typhoon resulted in more than 6,000 deaths, more than 4.1 million people displaced from their homes, and more than 14.1 million people in 36 provinces affected. The most affected areas were the east coast of Leyte, and the south coasts of Samar and Eastern Samar, in the Eastern Visayas regions. These areas were affected by a tidal surge comparable to a tsunami; devastation from extreme winds and rain was also catastrophic.

The IASC principles activated a system-wide level 3 emergency response to the disaster. Measures accompanying the L3 declaration included providing the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) with empowered leadership, deployment of a Deputy Humanitarian Coordinator for the first three months, allocating USD 25 million from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF), and sending enhanced surge capacity through the Inter-Agency Rapid Response Mechanism (IARRM). In line with the L3 declaration, UNDP immediately declared an internal level 3 response and responded with an immediate response team that was on the ground from day 4 of the crisis and an enhanced SURGE team with capacity for both programme and early recovery coordination. Other internal crisis response measures, including a Crisis Board, were also activated from the onset of the crisis.

As per level three protocols, in February 2014, an Operational Peer Review was conducted by the UN, to assess the (i) leadership arrangements; (ii) application of the humanitarian programme cycle; (iii) use of appropriate coordination arrangements; and (iv) accountability to affected people. Additionally other agencies and INGOs have also undertaken an assessment of the international response to the crisis and tabled learning to the wider development community in the Philippines. In addition an Inter-Agency Humanitarian evaluation (IAHE) of the response to Haiyan is scheduled to take place in August of 2014 aimed to improve humanitarian policy-making, as well as UN agencies approach to future emergencies.

In this context, it is expected that an After Action Review (AAR) will provide a comprehensive assessment of UNDP's response to Typhoon Haiyan in Philippines will aim to inform the continuous enhancements of UNDP's crisis response systems and tools and processes by gathering facts and perceptions related to UNDP's response and suggesting actionable recommendations to improve UNDP's future response operations. The review will therefore hopefully contribute to the overall improvement of the timeliness and effectiveness of UNDP response to emergencies resulting from disasters due to natural hazards. The AAR is in line with corporate procedures corresponding to this magnitude of crisis, and will serve as an internal learning exercise. Key learnings from this review may feed into the IAHE process as well as shared with partners as a part of collective learnings and experience sharing.

B. Objective of the Haiyan After Action Review

The objective of the AAR is to:

- Examine the performance of UNDP with respect to the response to Typhoon Haiyan, and highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response to disasters, including: UNDPs corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to PDNA and recovery processes. The AAR will also draw recommendations for future crisis response situations.

Keys issues

The AAR will address the following:

Overall Response

- i. Examine the appropriateness of UNDP's response in the context of an L3 crisis;
- ii. Review the decision-making processes and their efficiency in the context of the overall response;
- iii. Examine UNDP's ability to take on a "whole of UNDP" approach to the response and recovery efforts;
- iv. Review UNDP's overall preparedness for the response (CO, regional, global)

Programmatic Response

- v. Review the pertinence of UNDP's recovery programme formulation and the choices that were made in terms of programme priorities; the reasons why those choices were made; programmatic performance overall;
- vi. Assess whether a link was made with UNDP's corporate signature products for recovery situations;
- vii. Examine whether adjustments were made to the existing country programme in response to the Haiyan (including the identification of new programmes);

Operational Response

- viii. The timeliness and effectiveness of the overall response operation and the compliance and application of the SOPs and decision-making processes. This part of the review will focus on both country level and HQ level responses, in addition to the interaction between the two;
- ix. Review the efficiency and effectiveness of immediate crisis response standard operating procedures, as well as analyze their application in the context of Haiyan response. This includes but is not limited to the application of Fast Track procedures and rapid response processes (financing, recruitment, etc.);

- x. Review the relevance and timeliness of the SURGE work plan, and quality of SURGE deployments and management of SURGE advisors in country;
- xi. Examine whether recommendations tabled following Haiti and Pakistan After Action reviews of 2011 were implemented in responding to the Haiyan crisis;
- xii. Examine the operational bottlenecks and constraints faced by the CO in terms of both operations and programme implementation;

UN and Interagency Coordination:

- xiii. The effectiveness and adequacy of UNDP's engagement with the broader humanitarian action. Including a review of:
 - a. The extent of UNDP's coordination and cooperation with key humanitarian partners on the ground;
 - b. UNDP's engagement in the entire humanitarian programme cycle;
 - c. UNDP's leadership of the Early Recovery Cluster on the ground in supporting recovery;
 - d. Clarity of UNDP's role and actions vis-à-vis other partners, including other clusters;
 - e. UNDP's ability to link immediate early recovery to longer term recovery efforts;
 - f. UNDP's support to Government coordination capacities;
 - g. UNDP's engagement in the wider planning processes of recovery.

UNDP's Engagement in and Influence on Assessment Processes

- xiv. UNDP's ability to build synergies and mainstream the recovery agenda in the needs assessment processes (such as MIRA, PDNA and RAY) and humanitarian funding instruments;

Resource Mobilization:

- xv. Assess donor response to the UNDP programme, identifying gaps and areas for improvement;
- xvi. Assess donor response to the overall ER agenda and UNDP leadership of the ER cluster;
- xvii. Examine the effectiveness of communication and resource mobilization efforts;
- xviii. Examine internal and external factors that impacted donor funding decisions, identifying areas for improvement.

The expected deliverables of the AAR:

The review will cover UNDP's response to Typhon Haiyan and will focus on the period starting 12th November 2013 to date, which corresponds to the extended SURGE period. The review will cover all aspects of UNDP's response and its role in the interagency arenas. The review cover UNDP HQ, regional presence in Bangkok and the Philippines Country Office.

The recommendations will have a forward-looking view, with aim to identifying best practices and innovations that can be systematized, as well as practices that need to be avoided in the future. It will also define areas for further investment and improvement in the response. In addition the ARR will provide:

- A timeline providing an overview of facts and events;
- Overview of recommendations implemented / not implemented from past AARs;
- A final report on lessons learned focussing on key issues as highlighted in the objectives above;
- Forward looking Action Plan for implementing recommendations;
- Facilitate a multi- stakeholder sharing the findings and recommendations

C. Methodology, Timeline and Team

An independent, external evaluation team will be recruited to conduct the after action review. The review team will consist of a team leader and a senior consultant with a recovery background. The team will report to a HQ advisory group consisting of RBAP, BCPR, BOM and BERA, through the BCPR M&E Team who will oversee the day-to-day management of the team. The final report will be presented to the Philippines Crisis Board for review and endorsement.

Timeline for the review will be June –July 2014.

Information will be gathered from primary and secondary sources. This includes desk reviews, key informant interviews in headquarters with central and regional bureaus involved, the country office and deployed personnel. Meetings with partners and stakeholders, field visits, focus group meetings with stakeholders and surveys.

Annex II.

List of People interviewed

Names	Position
Adam Marlatt	Logistics Coordinator for the Timber Retrieval and Storage Program
Aiden Short	MSB Debris Specialist
Alma Evangelista	CPRU Team Leader
Amelia Supetran	Team Leader, Energy and Environment
Amillah Rodil	Project Officer, UN-Habitat
Amita Gill	Programme Specialist (Governance), BCPR
Astghik Martirosyan	RBM, M&E Specialist, Focal Point
Bruno Lemarquis	Chief of CSMT
Charu Bist	Livelihoods Specialist, BCPR
Christopher Rollo	Country Programme Manager, UN-Habitat
Christopher Sheen P. Gonzales	Guiuan Municipality Mayor
Dennis Curry	Senior Recovery Coordinator
Devanand Ramiah	
Eden Garde	Project Manager
Emmanuel Buendia	Team Leader, Democratic Governance
Faiza Effendi	Programme Specialist – SE Asia and Pacific Division
George Khoury	Team Leader (RSST and CS
Haoliang Xu	RBAP Director
Hiroko Araki	Resource Mobilization Specialist, BCPR
Jahal De Meritens	Early Recovery Advisor
James Abdul	Area Coordinator
Jeff Johnson	Director, ILO
Jelena Vladicic	External Relations Analyst
Jens Wandel	Director, BOM
Jo Scheuer	Coordinator Disaster Risk Reduction and Recovery, BCPR
Jordan Ryan	BCPR Director
Jeremie Toussaint	ER Cluster Coordinator
Jose Abraham Ongkiko	Area Coordinator
Kamal Kishore	Programme Advisor, DRR, BCPR
Kasper Engborg	Head of Sub-Office, UN-OCHA
Krishna Vatsa	DRR Specialist
Laurel Patterson	Team Leader Donor Relations, BERA
Leslie Cordero	Undersecretary, Office of the Presidential Assistant for Rehabilitation and Recovery (OPARR)
Lesley Wright	Communications Consultant
Luiza Carvalho,	UN Resident Coordinator/UNDP Resident Representative

Margaret Sheehan, Chief Operations	OIC/Deputy Representative, UNICEF
Maria Theresa Dela Cruz	Project Officer
Maurice Dewoulf	Country Director, UNDP Philippines
Narue Shiki	SURGE, Advisor to RC
Nicholas Rosellini	Deputy Regional Director
Phillip Cooper	Senior Recovery Coordinator
Rafi Tokhi	Operations Manager
Rekha Das	Early Recovery Advisor
Rey Gozon,	Assistant Regional Director, OCD
Sanny Jegillos	Regional Practice Coordinator
Saumik De	Programme Specialist (recruitment, RSST
Sonny Ongkiko	DILG
Sunil Saigal	Director
Tim Walsh	Waste Management Specialist
Toshihiro Tanaka	(Ex) Philippines CD till Feb, 2014
Vineet Bhatia	Chief- South East Asia and Pacific Division
Yuri Afanasiev	UN RC/RR SURGE Senior Recovery Specialist

Annex III

SURGE Deployment Tracking Matrix

TRACKING MATRIX - CRISIS RESPONSE TYPHOON HAIYAN (2013) - 13 January 2014

NAME		PROFILE	DEPLOYMENT	RETURN	MODALITY	DUTY STATION
Support to UNDP CO						
1	Tim Walsh	Debris Management	17-Nov	17-May	Consultant / Express Roster	Tacloban City
2	Sanny Jegillos	Disaster Risk Reduction	13-Nov	TBD	Staff/SURGE	Manila
3	Noel Puno	Disaster/recovery	11-Nov	TBC	Local consultant	Tacloban City
4	Joseph D'Cruz	Environment	18-Nov	TBD	Staff/SURGE	Manila
5	Yuri Afanasiev	Senior Recovery Coordinator	19-Nov	TBC	Staff/SURGE	Manila
6	Faisal Ridwan	Debris Management	20-Nov	31-Dec	Consultant / Express Roster	Tacloban City
7	Lesley Wright	Debris Management - Comms	21-Nov	31-Dec	Consultant / Express Roster	Tacloban City
8	Krishna Vatsa	Disaster Risk Management	13-Dec	TBD	Staff/SURGE	Manila
Support to the HC/RC function for Early Recovery						
9	Dennis Johnson	Early Recovery Advisor (ERA)	21-Nov	4-Mar	Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
10	Yvonne Radamacher	Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator (ERCC)	2-Dec	5-Mar	Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
11	Lisa Guppy	Early Recovery Information Management	14-Dec	7-Mar	Consultant / Stand By Partner	Manila
12	Salla Himberg	Early Recovery Information Management	8-Dec	8-Mar	Consultant / Stand By Partner	Manila
SURGE Plan Implementation						

13	Lisa Hiller	Communications	8-Jan	4-Apr	Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
14	Jelena Vladicic	Resource Mobilization	16-Dec	14-Feb	Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
15	Mohammad Rafi Tokhi	Operations	13-Jan	TBC	Staff/SURGE	Manila
16	Olga Cherekova	CPR Programme Office	8-Jan	TBC	Staff/SURGE	Manila
17	S.K.Singhal	Finance	14-Jan	7-Apr	Staff/SURGE	Manila
18		M&E			Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
19		Disaster Risk Rediction			Consultant / Express Roster	Manila
20		Civil Engineer Specialist			IUNV	Tacloban/Field
21		Livelihoods and SME Specialist –			IUNV	Tacloban/Field
22		Livelihoods Specialist			IUNV	Tacloban/Field
23		Local Governance			IUNV	Tacloban/Field
24		Livelihoods Agriculture			IUNV	Tacloban/Field
25		National UNVs (15)			NUNV	Tacloban/Field

Concluded deployments

Support to UNDP CO						
19	Stanislav Saling	Communications	16-Nov	22-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
20	Narue Shiki	Senior Liaison Officer	19-Nov	23-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
21	Amita Gill	Local Governance	5-Dec	22-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
22	Jo Scheuer	Disaster Risk Management	2-Dec	17-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
23	Per Berg	Disaster waste management expert	1-Dec	14-Nov	Standby roster	Tacloban City

Support to the HC/RC function for Early Recovery						
24	Jahal de Meritens	Early Recovery Advisor (ERA)	12-Nov	22-Nov	Staff/ SURGE	Manila
25	Christophe Chabron	Early Recovery (Cluster Coordination)	4-Dec	17-Nov	Staff/SURGE	TBC
26	Rekha Das	Early Recovery Cluster Coordinator (ERCC)	12-Nov	22-Nov	Staff/SURGE	Manila / Tacloban City

SURGE Planning Team						
27	Bruno Lemarquis	Team Leader - Recovery	24-Nov	5-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
28	Mohammad Rafi Tokhi	Operations	24-Nov	5-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
29	Kamal Kishore	Disaster Management/Early Recovery	24-Nov	17-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
30	Taija Kintinen-Sharp	Programme	16-Dec	23-Nov	Staff/SURGE	Manila
31	Charu Bist	Programme - Livelihoods	28-Nov	29-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila
32	Thusitha Piliapitiya	Programme - Governance	25-Jan	4-Dec	Staff/SURGE	Manila

